

The Lord of the Rings Roleplaying

Phases of Play (5E) - Player-hero & Loremaster reference

Play alternates between two phases. Adventuring Phases cover the deeds of the Company in detail. Fellowship Phases cover rest and preparation, often spanning weeks or months before the next adventure begins.

ADVENTURING PHASE



Adventuring Phase

Active play resolved day by day and scene by scene. The Company journeys, treats with the Wise, and faces the Shadow. Time passes slowly here.



Heroic Ventures

Combat, exploration, and deeds of courage. Uses the usual 5E action economy (action, bonus action, reaction, move) tailored to Middle-earth.



Council

A formal gathering with important NPCs - to seek aid, counsel, or offer service. Open with introductions, roleplay the meeting, then resolve with ability checks based on the request and the NPC's attitude.



Journey

Travel across the wild. Plan a route on the map, assign Journey roles, then resolve events along the way. Travel is part of the adventure, not just downtime between scenes.



Journey Roles

Guide - leads the Company and sets the path. Hunter - finds food and tracks. Look-out - watches for danger. Scout - surveys the land ahead. Role checks resolve many journey events.

FELLOWSHIP PHASE



Fellowship Phase

Downtime between Adventuring Phases. Weeks or months may pass 'off-screen' at a Safe Haven while heroes rest, recover, and prepare.



Safe Haven

A place of rest and refuge (a Patron's hall, a friendly settlement, or a sanctuary). Heroes recover here; the road is no place for a true rest from the Shadow.



Undertakings

Each Player-hero chooses what to do with their free time. Examples: gather rumours, meet your Patron, study lore or maps, raise an heir, heal Shadow scars, or examine magical items and Rewards.



Yule

A special year-end Fellowship Phase. Time advances on the Tale of Years. Yule phases are typically longer and allow more Undertakings than a short rest between adventures.



Fellowship & Patron

Fellowship Points are a shared Company resource - spend them (by agreement) for aid such as advantage. Your Patron may also grant unique boons when points are spent or when you Meet Patron as an Undertaking.

Phase cycle reminders

Cycle of play: Adventuring Phase (Journey / Council / Heroic Ventures) -> Fellowship Phase (rest, Undertakings, recover Shadow) -> next Adventuring Phase. | Shadow is often gained while adventuring and eased during Fellowship. | Loremaster narrates broadly in Fellowship; detail returns when adventure resumes.